04/13/2010
Revised 10/01/2026

OPR: WVOT Datacenter

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS POLICY IS MANDATORY

Questions and change recommendations related to this publication shall be directed to this publication's Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR). This policy shall be reviewed annually to ensure continued alignment with current legal, operational, and strategic requirements. Revisions will be undertaken as necessary.

SUMMARY OF VERSIONS AND CHANGES

Date	Revision Description
7/1/2015	Added Change Log History and Policy Specific Definitions
9/1/2016	Policy Review - No Changes
10/20/2017	Policy Review - No Changes
12/28/2023	Updated WVOT policies link and added information for Appendix A in par. 3.1.4
9/17/2025	Name changed from Data ~~Retention~~ to Data Protection and Backup. Reformatted to match the new policy template. Para. 3.1.2, 3.1.2.1, and 3.1.6 added or substantially changed. All mainframe references removed.
10/01/2026	Deleted 3.1.2.1 and 3.1.9 because of redundant language and made minor administrative updates.

1.0 PURPOSE

1.1 This policy establishes standardized requirements and expectations for availability, protection, and backup of data on the State of West Virginia's executive domain.

2.0 SCOPE

2.1 This policy applies to all departments (including agencies, boards, authorities, and commissions) within the Executive Branch of WV State Government, excluding constitutional officers, the WV Board of Education, the WV Department of Education, and the county boards of education that have access to or use State-provided resources.

2.2 This policy supersedes any policy in place that provides less restrictions or reduced security.If existing state and federal laws, regulations, and policies are more restrictive than this policy, those more restrictive provisions will prevail.

3.0 POLICY

3.1 Server Backup and Recovery

3.1.1 WVOT utilizes an enterprise data backup system to ensure that agency programs, files, and datasets are properly backed up and retained.

3.1.2 All data that is essential to the continuity of agency operations must be identified by the owning agency and a backup service request must be submitted to The Office of Technology via the WVOT Self Support Portal. Non-critical data that an agency elects to have backed up must follow the same request process as critical data.

3.1.2.2 Agencies with special backup needs exceeding the requirements of this policy will be identified through technical risk analysis, and will be accommodated on a case-by-case basis.

3.1.2.3 Agencies will be charged for storage at the rate defined in the WVOT rates catalog.

3.1.4 Server data backups will be performed based on recovery point objectives. (See Attachment A in PO1006 for information on Business Criticality Classes.) If the agency has not defined recovery point objectives, the standard default for data backup will be nightly.

3.1.5 WVOT will monitor backups, address technical issues related to server data backup, and notify agencies of instances when information has not been backed-up according to plan. However, agencies must test to ensure that the backed-up data is accurate and complete.

3.1.6 The WVOT only supports backup operations for hardware and software that are currently within their supported lifecycle.Backup and restore operations for hardware or software that have reached end-of-life status may be attempted on a best-effort basis, with no guarantee of success or support.

3.1.7 Agency personnel requesting data recovery and restoration must contact the WVOT Service Desk either by phone at (304) 558-9966 or by email at servicedesk@wv.gov All requests are logged and tracked in the incident management system.

3.1.8 Data server backup and recovery efforts do not provide disaster recovery services. Additional arrangements must be made for full restoration of operating systems, directory services, etc.

3.4 Backup Modifications/Schedule Configuration Changes

3.4.1 Modifications to the supported environment will be determined between the agency and the WVOT prior to implementation. WVOT will perform upgrades to the system, when required, and notify the agency of any changes.

4.0 POLICY-SPECIFIC DEFINITIONS

4.1 Employee – Individuals retained and authorized on a temporary, part-time, full-time, or permanent basis by the State of West Virginia to perform a service. For the purposes of information technology and security policy, the term “employee” shall include, but not be limited to, the following: contractors, subcontractors, contractors’ employees, volunteers, county health department staff, business associates, and any other persons who are determined and notified by the WVOT to be subject to this policy. This definition does not create any additional rights or duties.

4.2 Chief Information Officer (CIO) - the person designated by the governor to lead the WV Office of Technology and oversee information technology practices and initiatives for the Executive Brand of WV State government, excluding the constitutional officers.

4.3 Office of Primary Responsibility or (OPR) - The primary section within WVOT that takes the lead on a specific policy or procedure. Usually the WVOT service provider/owner that the policy is related to or governs.

4.4 User – A person authorized to access an information resource.

4.5 West Virginia Office of Technology (WVOT) - The division of the Department of Administration established by WV Code § 5A-6, *et. seq.,* which is led by the State’s CIO.

5.0 RELEVANT MATERIALS AND DOCUMENTS

5.1 WV Code § 5A-6.
https://code.wvlegislature.gov/5A-6/

5.2 WVOT Policies Issued by the Chief Information Officer (CIO)
https://technology.wv.gov/